



Delaware County Council Meeting March 18th 2021

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YCIBu30vuxM
Publication Date	2021-03-18T22:26:21Z
Target Category	delaware_county

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: March 18, 2021

Convened Time: 9:08 AM

Body: Delaware County Council

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

No statutory public hearings or committee work sessions were held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer Mr. Alexander called the meeting to order at 9:08 AM **00:00:20**, noting a slight delay due to technical difficulties.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Ballard, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lasseter, Ms. Piper, Mr. Quakenbush, Mr. Webb, Mr. Alexander, and Mr. Hughes.
 - **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Alexander.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Ron 00:00:24.
 - **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was confirmed as posted and advertised. Approved via roll call vote (7-0).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the February 23 meeting were approved via roll call vote (7-0), following a minor correction on page 5 regarding part-time positions noted by Mr. Quakenbush.
-

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:54 Presentation: Sheriff Tony Skinner on the DROP Program**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff Tony Skinner
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Sheriff Skinner requested the removal of the sunset clause on the Deferred Retirement Option Plan (DROP) program, which is set to expire on July 1st, making it a permanent option for the department. He highlighted that DROP provides deputies with up to three years of lump-sum pension payments upon retirement while freezing their retirement calculation date, giving the county up to three extra years of experienced service at a cost-neutral framework. Council members expressed caution and skepticism regarding long-term pension impacts, citing national concerns with public pension plans. Discussions centered on whether to implement another multi-year sunset clause to allow continued review.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** No final vote was taken; the matter will return to a future agenda for further review with legal and administrative input.
- **00:22:57 Transfer Agenda: Circuit Court**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requests covered transferring funds for jail video court equipment upgrades (\$6,600) and unfreezing/refilling an assistant court reporter position (\$23,235) that was held vacant during the pandemic as in-person hearings and jury trials resume.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:26:20 Transfer Agenda: Emergency Management**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John Latino
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Internal transfer moving a previous secretary position line to a newly hired secretary position line. Total request: \$0.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:27:50 Transfer Agenda: Communication Center (911)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Paul Singleton, 911 Director

- **Deliberation Summary:** Funds transferred to backfill two full-time employee positions starting March 25th. Director Singleton noted ongoing staffing shortages, active social media recruitment campaigns, and upcoming retirements/departures. Total request: \$0.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:32:00 Transfer Agenda: Jail / Corrections**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff Tony Skinner / Staff
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Administrative line-item corrections and transfers to backfill personnel positions, including a corporal and a lieutenant retirement. Total request: \$0.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:35:22 Transfer Agenda: Clerk Perpetuation Fund**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick / Clerk's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$10,000 from file storage hardware to office furniture to replace mismatched furniture and chairs resulting from the office's move to the new building. Total request: \$0.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:36:39 Transfer Agenda: Emergency Medical Service (EMS)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Maggi Latino, Office Manager
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Filling a previous EMT position left vacant by a resignation last year by recalling a laid-off employee based on seniority. Total request: \$0.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:38:19 Transfer Agenda: General County Clerk**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Clerk's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$5,384 for the Chief Registration Officer pay line, an item omitted from the initial budget created when the clerk took over voter registration administration.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:40:14 Transfer Agenda: Building Fund**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / HR
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$1,361 for badges and badge-machine maintenance as oversight shifts to HR.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:41:38 Transfer Agenda: EDIT Projects**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Administration
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual appropriation of \$3,000,000 for EDIT projects under the active EDIT plan running from 2019 to next year.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:43:10 Transfer Agenda: Emergency Management (Ball Foundation Grant)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John Latino

- **Deliberation Summary:** Re-encumbering \$4,883 from last year's Ball Foundation grant for a drone engine/equipment. The council praised the expanding drone program utilized for missing persons and mutual aid.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:46:37 Transfer Agenda: Reassessment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Assessor's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Minor transfer of \$71 for health insurance shortfalls.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:47:16 Transfer Agenda: Sales Disclosure Fund**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** James (Assessor's Office)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$6,522 for association dues, pictometry aerial imagery acquisition support, and computer monitors to improve personal property online filing efficiency. *(Initially tabled due to absence, then removed from table and approved).*
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously.
- **00:49:27 Transfer Agenda: Project Income (DCCC)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth Batt, DCCC
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$15,000 to cover the salary difference for a peer recovery coach through the end of the opioid grant cycle.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:51:02 Transfer Agenda: GIS / COVID Grant**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$5,000 (\$3,600 contractual, \$1,400 equipment) funded by local foundations to continue weekly COVID-19 communications and press releases for an additional six weeks.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:52:11 Transfer Agenda: Health Department (Ball Brothers Grant)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jamie<U+6CB3> (Health Department)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$25,500 (\$1,805 contractual services for EMS paramedics observing vaccination reactions, \$1,000 supplies, \$22,600 staff meals) to support extended vaccination clinic hours and weekend operations. *(Initially tabled due to absence, then removed from table and approved).*
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously.
- **00:48:50 Transfer Agenda: Enhanced 9-1-1**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Paul Singleton, 911 Director
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$600,000 from state 9-1-1 accounts to partially pay a 10-year lease/installation bill (\$1.395 million total) for the new 9-1-1 phone system. State grants will reimburse a portion of these costs.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
- **01:13:02 Transfer Agenda: Board of Health (CARES Act Grant)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jamie<U+6CB3> (Health Department)

- **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$80,640 (\$67,850 overtime, \$5,190 FICA, \$7,600 PERF) to fund staff overtime for COVID-19 vaccination clinics, preventing excessive comp time accrual.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
 - **01:20:18 Omnibus Financial & Personnel Approvals**
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Motion to approve financial transfers, amend the salary ordinance with like reductions, and amend hiring freeze ordinance 2020-015.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
 - **01:09:52 Ordinances for Second Reading: Ordinance 2021-006**
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Second reading of an ordinance adjusting part-time wages specifically for custodial maintenance staff.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved (Vote recorded with dissent/abstention from Mr. Alexander and Mr. Ballard).
-

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No general open public comment period or citizen forum speakers were recorded during this session.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Sheriff Skinner invited all seven council members to visit the new jail and spend a few hours in the control room to observe corrections operations.
 - Mr. Alexander encouraged community blood donations via Vitalant for free antibody testing and expressed hope that pandemic restrictions and mask mandates would soon ease.
 - **Adjournment:** Official adjournment approved via roll call vote.
-

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-10-04 04:37:12 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.